

apionekey.com — Competitive Positioning Brief

Identity Governed Logic (IGL) for Artificial Intelligence

“Who am I? Who are we?” — the two questions every AI model must answer before it acts.

1 • Category Position

The market already has AI gateways, MCP gateways, agent identities, and relationship-based authorization — as separate, fragmented products. apionekey.com unifies them around one construct: the **Identity Graph** of the individual or the company. Once the graph is established, every approved AI model operates under the same deterministic authority, delegation, and resource boundaries — enforced outside the model, not inside its reasoning.

2 • The IGL Core — “Who am I? Who are we?”

- **Who am I?** — the individual Identity Graph: identity, representation, authority, resources, and the delegations a person has granted to agents, models, and other graphs.
- **Who are we?** — the company Identity Graph: ownership, roles, policies, resource coverage, and the delegations the organization extends to its own and third-party agents.

A conventional gateway key asks: *Is this key valid? Can it call this model? Is it under budget?* An **IGL key** asks: Which identity does this represent? Which graph governs it? What authority was computed? Which model version is authorized? Which resources are covered? May this model use this MCP tool? Is the delegation still valid — and did it originate in another graph?

The chain: Identity Graph → UDM authority computation → IGL Master Key → model & exact-version activation → scoped bearer keys → AI + MCP enforcement → cross-graph delegation → deterministic audit.

3 • Threat Matrix

Threat	What they own	IGL differentiation	Posture
Strata Identity	Closest: MCP bridge/proxy, agent authn, user→agent delegation, scope enforcement	Graph-bound identity + model/exact-version binding above the gateway	Monitor closely
PlainID	Policy-centric authorization for agentic AI, data-level filtering, MCP governance	Graph-centric and key-portable: the transaction is bound to the identity, not just the policy	Out-position
OpenFGA	Relationship-based authorization (Zanzibar-style); commoditizes ReBAC and act-on-behalf-of	The moat is the governed graph + deterministic authority — not the authorization check	Integrate or out-position
MS Entra Agent ID	Enterprise agent IAM: distinct agent identities, lifecycle, Conditional Access, sponsorship	Cross-provider portable graph; Entra governs a tenant, IGL governs the identity itself	Integrate as identity source — do not compete head-on
AI gateways (OpenRouter et al.)	One credential across many model providers, routing, budgets, logging	One <i>governed identity</i> across selected models and exact versions	Leapfrog
MCP gateways (TrueFoundry, Bifrost, et al.)	Agent→tool authentication, discovery, tool-level access control	Tool access derived from identity lineage: whose authority, from which graph, still valid?	Subsume

4 • Moat Claims — the Defensible Process IP

- **Graph establishment** — the process by which an individual's or company's Identity Graph is created and governed.
- **Deterministic authority computation** — UDM computes authority from the graph; outcomes are explainable and reproducible.
- **Bounded coverage** — authority becomes coverage, applied to specific models and exact versions.
- **Key as live reference** — the IGL key references current authority state; it is not a static credential.
- **Cross-graph delegation without merging** — derived authority can only be equal to or narrower than its source.
- **Revocation propagation** — across models, agents, tools, and sessions, deterministically.

5 • Buyer Wedge

Primary buyer: compliance / risk owner, with the CISO. Deterministic auditability — every AI action traceable to a governed identity and a computed authority — is a **compliance purchase, not an infrastructure purchase**. Gateways sell to platform engineering; IGL sells certainty to the people who answer to regulators, auditors, and courts.

Bottom Line

The moat is the graph and the deterministic authority model — not the gateway, the key, or the proxy; those are reproducible features. Gateways can bolt identity on later. An identity-first architecture cannot be retrofitted.

apionekey.com: the market has AI gateways, MCP gateways, agent identities, and authorization graphs — we unify them around who you are.